

Section B: *Viva voce*

20 marks

Candidates are required to have listened to, and compared, at least **two** interpretations of music relevant to the style or genre that is the focus of their recital in **Section A** and to have supported their study by appropriate research. Using the *viva voce* preparation form (example, Appendix C, p. 85) as a starting-point, the examiner will explore, through discussion with the candidate, the relationship between the candidate's listening and reading and the interpretative choices made in performing the recital programme.

Candidates should be able to:

- demonstrate an in-depth understanding of their focus style or genre and the different performing choices and conventions associated with it;
- show awareness of different interpretative possibilities;
- explain their interpretative decisions; and
- appraise the effectiveness of their decisions in their performance.

Candidates may, if they wish, illustrate their points by demonstrating on their own instrument (or voice).

The discussion will last about **five** minutes.

Unit Content

The Area of Study **Interpretation** determines the principal focus of this unit. Critical listening is central to developing awareness of how interpretations may differ and to informing the candidate's decisions about interpretative aspects of their own performance.

Section A: Recital

Many candidates may choose to continue the study of the solo instrument (or voice) on which they performed in **Section A** of **Unit G351: *Performing Music 1***, extending their technical and expressive control and developing their stylistic awareness. Some may choose to offer a different instrument, or voice, or to perform in a different *rôle*, developing their skills in ensemble-playing or as an accompanist. (Accompaniments may be played on any instrument that is suitable for the style of the music presented. As with recitals presented solo or in ensemble, the programme must have a specific emphasis, demonstrated, for example, through performance of one or more movements from a violin sonata in which the candidate plays the piano part, or a group of songs by Dowland in which the candidate plays the lute or guitar.)

Each candidate's course of study should be tailored to the individual instrument (or voice), whether performed solo, in ensemble, or as an accompaniment, and should focus on a significant aspect of its repertoire. The specific nature of the instrument (or voice) will suggest characteristic repertoire but may also impose some constraints. Candidates are expected to deepen their understanding of the repertoire by choosing a defined style or genre as the focus for their study.

Candidates should be given opportunities to learn about the nature of the medium that they have chosen, and to acquire knowledge about its principal genres and their development, before deciding which specific style or genre to study in depth. This should normally be one that is recognised as representative of the instrument or voice-type and its standard repertoire (e.g. Weber's music for clarinet, Satriani's music for guitar, Cole Porter's songs) but an equally valid form of study may focus on a less commonly-known style or genre. The focus for study should be one that both promotes the development of the candidate's technical and expressive control and lends itself to interpretative understanding.

The listening and research undertaken should reflect the focus of the recital programme and contribute to the candidate's understanding of interpretative aspects of performance. At least two contrasting performances of music related to the focus of the candidate's programme should be studied and compared, supported by relevant reading.

All candidates should be encouraged to participate in a wide range of musical activities to provide a broad canvas against which to deepen their understanding of the Area of Study **Interpretation**.

Section B: Viva voce

This section of the unit builds on the discussion in **Unit G351: *Performing Music 1* (Section B)**. Whilst the emphasis at AS Level was already on self-reflection, with candidates commenting on the effects of their decisions about expressive and technical features in their own performing, here they will be expected additionally to show how comparative listening to interpretations and background research has also informed their performing decisions. In their listening they should learn to recognise and comment on salient differences in terms of technical and expressive interpretation and in ways of realising performing conventions. In order to be able to respond confidently to the examiner's questions they will need to develop, and learn to articulate, their awareness of different interpretations and to discuss the choices and decisions that contribute to their own.

The *viva voce* preparation form (see example, Appendix C, p 85) should be compiled as a log of listening and reading carried out during the course. Candidates should learn early on how to record details of recordings that they listen to, books and articles they read and internet sources that they access, in a scholarly fashion using standard bibliographical conventions. They should be encouraged to take full advantage of the opportunities offered on the form to comment on what they hear, recording their observations on interpretative features in brief notes.

Before handing the form to the examiner at the beginning of the day on which the examination takes place, candidates may wish to photocopy the form so that they can use it as an *aide mémoire* in the discussion.

3.5 A2 Unit G355: *Composing 2*

Assessment

Teacher-Assessed Portfolio

Candidates are required to submit a portfolio representative of work undertaken from **Section A** and **Section B** throughout the course.